on shore in fact the advice of the most experienced people here was to insure nothing, but having stated these particulars, and leaving my own opinion out of the question I must leave it to you. We start on Sunday, the day after tomorrow and you may suppose we are much hurried, in this has been the case with us ever since our arrival, you will hear again very shortly from Trebizonde, I hope.

Edward is in perfect health and I hope happy. We both go this evening to dine with Sir R. Gordon[13] who has been particularly kind to me and desired that E. should be introduced to him. He acquits himself very well in society.

[CHARLES BURGESS TO HENRY BURGESS] *Erzeroum, January 17, 1831*

At length I have the happiness to address you from this place, having arrived yesterday night, after a journey by sea from Constantinople to Trebizonde, and by caravan in 13 days from thence. The Black Sea treated us very civilly, our passage was eleven days during which we were more frightened than hurt, although from the state of ship and Captain we have every reason to be thankful the goods are perfectly safe, and I believe not at all damaged either by sea or land. We were unfortunate in not seeing Mr. Brant at Trebizonde, he was gone to Erzeroum and after waiting three days to see him I was obliged to depart. I met him on the road during a snow storm on a mountain side, he was very civil but of course we could have very little communication. I shall write him from this.

I have great hopes of forming a connexion which may be advantageous. Mr. J. Hunter[14] to whom Mr. Cartwright[15] gave me the letter of introduction, I hear, is a very pleasant man, if he should fall in your way mention the reason which prevented my delivering the letter which was my connexion with poor Hart. As this reason is now alas no longer in force I should be very ready to enter into any arrangement which might be deemed expedient by him or Mr. Brant, mention also that I hope to be in England next autumn and shall certainly see him.

The news from Persia is good, plague and Cholera both over and every body returned to Tabreez and no further deaths. I am told on all sides that my goods will meet a very ready sale and think it most probable that I shall bring back silk if I can make it clear itself as it so much facilitates the getting off of my goods. Many people who have seen part of the samples of my assortment are much astonished at the good choice. They say there never was such a lot taken into Persia. If no revolution or popular commotion occurs I have every hope of doing

[13] Sir Robert Gordon, special British commissioner from the London conference (of England, France, and Russia) on Greek affairs, accredited to the Porte.

[14] Mr. J. Hunter, from the reference to Major Hart, would seem to have been a schoolmaster.

[15] Presumably Thomas Cartwright, secretary to the British embassy at The Hague.

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